

Brock USA's Email and Workflow Automation Strategy

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Agenda

1. Overview
2. Proposed Recommendation
3. Appendix



01 Overview



Project Objective

To move away from manual email sorting in Outlook and toward an AI-driven system that automatically handles email routing, so nothing falls through the cracks. This consists of benchmarking existing and new third-party tools to find a scalable solution that sorts internal and client-facing emails, while also providing Brock USA with the infrastructure needed to scale.

The Goal: Tool Implementation

1. Decide the best solution that addresses Brock USA's needs and pain points.
2. Finalize the purchase and execute a phased rollout to integrate the solution into daily operations.

The Challenges



01

The Shared Inbox Bottlenecks

sales@brockusa.com acts as a catch-all for everything, from internal team updates and marketing blasts to urgent customer sales and operations questions. Because everything lands in one spot, it is easy for important messages to fall through the cracks.

02

Email Routing

With a shared email, team members are receiving a high volume of emails that are not relevant to their daily responsibilities. There is a need for a way to filter and automatically assign these emails based on keywords.

03

Single Login, Multiple Users

Given the current environment, multiple users are signing in to the shared email with a single username and password. This current practice cannot be continued due to security risks.

04

Contact and Company Data

A disconnect between Outlook and HubSpot currently prevents contact and company data from being visible within the email experience. This forces manual cross-referencing between platforms, creating a bottleneck that makes responding more time-consuming and prone to information gaps.

A scenic mountain landscape at sunset or sunrise. The sky is a warm orange and yellow, transitioning into a clear blue. The mountains are rugged, with rocky peaks and slopes covered in dense green forest. The lighting creates a soft glow on the mountain ridges, highlighting their textures. A large, white, sans-serif number '02' is centered over the image, partially obscuring the mountain peaks.

02

Recommended Solution



Executive Summary: Strategic Transition to Hiver

<i>Recommendation</i>	Implement Hiver to centralize team communication, ensuring every client email is tracked, assigned, and automatically filtered to the correct owner.
<i>Strategic Impact & Logic</i>	• Elimination of internal email noise: replace email forwarding with AI-based email rerouting and custom email automation workflows, keeping the team focused on emails that need immediate attention. • Email management and visibility: gain 100% visibility into individual workloads and response quality, allowing leadership to identify bottlenecks and provide targeted support where team members are struggling. • Centralized email management: moving from individual Outlook folders to a shared inbox with automated email tagging and routing ensures all emails are tracked and assigned to a user, reducing the risk of missing client emails.
<i>Financial</i>	Hiver delivers a higher ROI by providing unlimited workflow automation at a lower price point (\$55 per user/month + 40% discount on 10 user seats) than Front, which imposes a 20-rule cap on the Pro plan (\$65 per user/month).

Selection Framework



Workflow Scalability

The selected solution must accommodate diverse email workflows through granular filtering. Platform can trigger actions based on specific criteria, including geographic region, individual contact, company domain, and keywords.



Visibility of Assigned Conversations

The solution must support total transparency even after an email has been assigned to an individual agent. This ensures that any team member can provide a status update or step in if an agent is out of office.



Onboarding & Support

The goal is immediate adoption. We are prioritizing a solution that feels natural from day one and offers personalized, human-led onboarding over a self-service support model.



Cost Efficiency

Our focus is not on the lowest entry price, but on maximizing feature-to-cost efficiency to ensure the highest 12-month return on investment.

Hiver vs Front

Features	Hiver (Pro)	Front (Pro)
<i>Personalized Onboarding</i>	2-3 weeks of hands-on training with a Hiver representative	Self-serve or onboarding manager (8h that includes, kick off call, consideration, recommendations, FAQ)
<i>Customer Support</i>	24/7 customer support with 3-minute response time	- 24/5 support team - Front academy (online course) - Live office hours, 1-2 times per week
<i>Shared Inbox</i>	Everyone sees the same shared emails, add your personal inbox, and see all emails being sent	Up to 5 separate inboxes that can be divided into separate workspaces
<i>Contact Cards & Customer Data</i>	HubSpot x Hiver integration gives you full access to all your HubSpot CRM data, which can be pulled into emails	Connect via the Front x HubSpot integration, you can see our contact and company profiles from your Front inbox
<i>Internal Collaboration & Communication</i>	100% visibility into all users' inboxes, you can assign emails to teammates when you are away, cross-collaboration when it comes to drafting emails	- Use mentions to add a user to the email thread - Subscribe inbox that tracks all emails you have been mentioned in
<i>AI Features</i>	Access to Hiver's AI agent, AI co-pilot, AI compose, AI summarize	AI topics, can buy other AI features as an add-on
<i>Workflow Automation</i>	Access to an unlimited number of workflows: - Contact based (email), domain, Round Robin, keywords, tags - AI automated	Access to 20 automation rules: - Tags, keywords, contact based
<i>Email Routing (for OOO)</i>	- You can schedule your holiday in advance, Hiver's Round Robin and Load Balancing will stop sending you emails - Unassign conversations if a reply is received while away - Move emails to a shared inbox	Use load balancing to help routes emails to the person with the fewest open conversations for when someone is on vacation
<i>User Seats</i>	10 users	20 users
<i>Price</i>	- \$55 per user per month for Pro plan - EoQ 40% discount on 10 user seats, \$2,640 in annual savings	- \$65 per user per month (20 seats max) - Onboarding cost \$3,000 - Total price (12 months): \$7,680.00 (including onboarding)

Hiver Quick Wins

Impact vs. Effort Matrix		
High Impact	Low Effort	High Effort
	Guided Hiver Onboarding: Hiver Manager helps with account migration, user setup, and training.	Connect Hiver with HubSpot: This may need some technical knowledge and support.
	Folder-to-Tag: Create tags for all existing email folders in Outlook	Workflow Automation: Decide the logic behind how you want to assign emails using OR/AND rules.
Minimal Impact	Workspace Personalization: Connect your personal email to Hiver and customize your Hiver view.	Cleaning Up Email Folders: Organize existing email folders and audit them prior to transferring them into Hiver tags.
	Email Templates: Copying and pasting your most-used email templates into Hiver's shared library.	Leverage Hiver Mentions: Transition the team away from forward/CC emails and using Hiver mentions and shared drafts to communicate internally.
	Share Email Drafts: Using the draft feature to let a teammate review an email before it is sent to a client.	Historical Emails and Data Cleanse: Audit and remove any email communications that are 4+ years old and no longer relevant to ensure GDPR compliance and reduce data liability.

90-day Implementation Roadmap

Phase 1: Account Setup (Weeks 1-3)	Phase 2: Execution (Weeks 3-6)	Phase 3: Optimization (Weeks 7-12)
Goal: Technical setup and employee training completed	Goal: Live email automation workflows and all users have fully adopted Hiver	Goal: Maximize operational efficiency and leverage AI to reduce manual workload
• Hiver Onboarding & Training: Scheduled calls with Hiver representatives to connect Hiver with Outlook and train all users on how to effectively use Hiver	• User Account Migration: Full migration of user profiles and shared inbox permissions from Outlook to the Hiver environment	• SLA (Service Level Agreement) implementation: Setting up automated alerts to notify users if an email stays unanswered beyond a specific period
	• Folder-to-Tag Mapping: 1:1 mapping of legacy Outlook folders into Hiver Shared Tags, ensuring historical context stays searchable	• Workflow Audit: Review team performance via Hiver Analytics to fine-tune round-robin routing and identify new automation opportunities to further reduce manual workload
• Success Metrics: All users feel confident in their ability to use Hiver (rerouting emails, creating automations, tagging emails and more)	• Email Automation: Set up email filtering logic using Hiver's automation workflow, deciding which users receive which emails	• Advanced Feature Expansion: Start exploring Hiver's AI tools such as its AI agent to help you when responding to client emails
	• Success Metrics: Go live on 5+ automated workflows, email resolution rate %, # missed emails/duplicate replies	• Success Metrics: Zero missed emails or duplicate replies across all shared inboxes, 100% SLA compliance

Appendix

1. New Platform Analysis
2. New Platform Deep-dive

05

The background image shows a modern interior space. In the upper left, two people are seated at a wooden reception desk; one is a man with curly hair in a dark blazer over a pink shirt, and the other is a woman wearing a grey sweater and a black hijab, looking at a laptop. To the right, a wide staircase with light-colored steps and wooden railings leads down. Several people are in motion on the stairs, appearing blurred. The walls are made of light-colored wood panels, and the overall atmosphere is bright and professional.

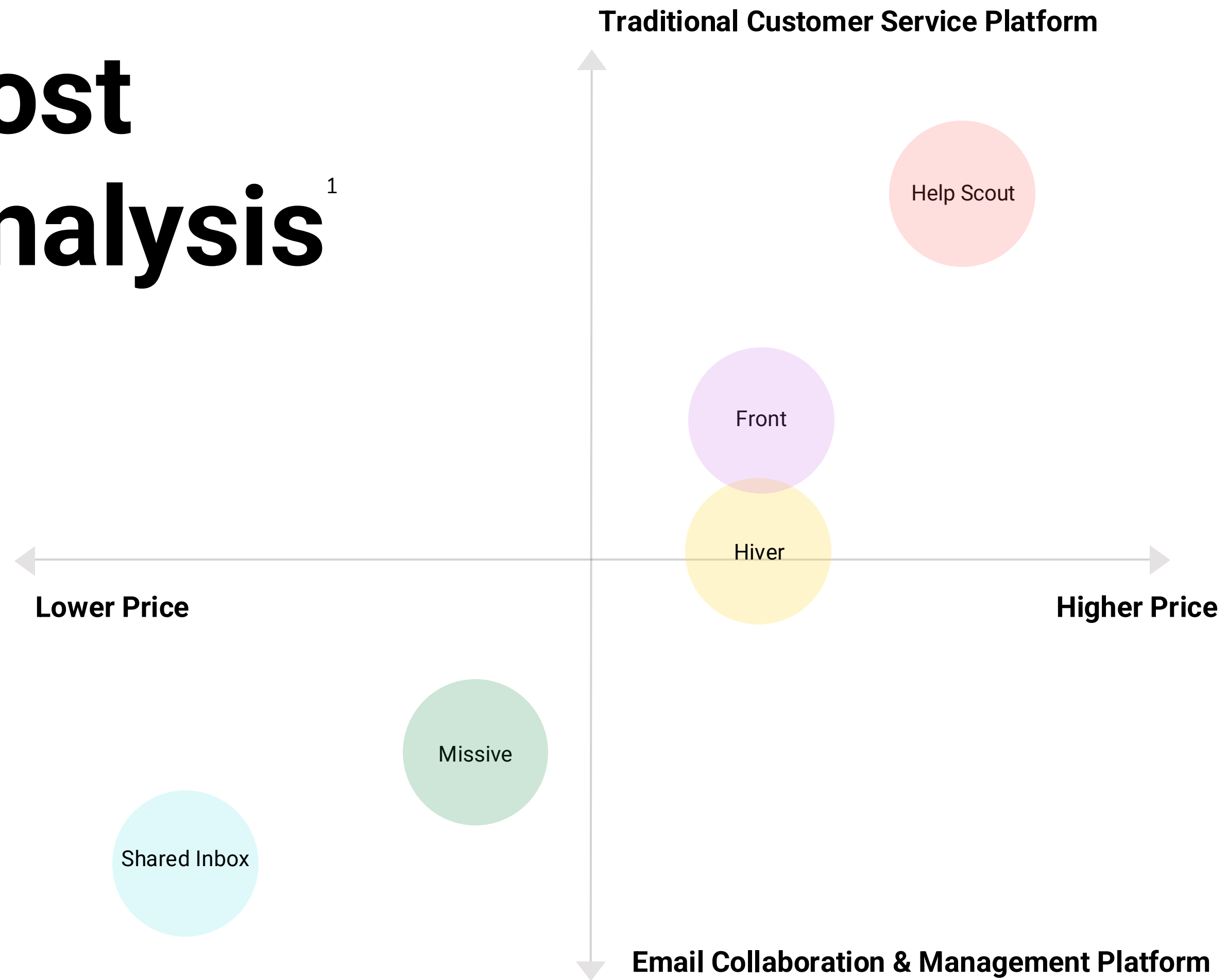
New tools

Platform Analysis

Platform Analysis

Features	Front	Hiver	Missive	Help Scout	Shared Inbox
Advantages	- Multi-channel - Email and CSM platform that turns all emails into tickets	- High quality customer onboarding and support - Unlimited workflows	- Leverages AI to automate workflows - Focus on email management with ticketing capabilities	- CSM platform that supports high growth CS teams - Advanced functionality and capabilities - Multi-channel	- Great for single channel communication and organization - Low cost - User friendly and easy to implement
Disadvantages	- AI functionality is an add-on - Onboarding support is an add-on - Limited number of workflows	Still developing Outlook features	New player in the market, not as well-known as Front or Hiver	Expensive	Limited features and scalability
Price	- Free Starter - \$25 per user/month Professional - \$65 per user/month Enterprise - \$105 per user/month	Free Growth – \$25 per user/month Pro - \$65 per user/month	Starter - \$18 per user/month Productive - \$30 per user/month Business - \$45 per user/month	Free Standard – \$30 per user/month Plus - \$54 per user/month Pro - \$90 per user/month	Starter - \$10 per user/month Business Plan - \$20 per user/month Scale Plan - \$30 per user/month
AI Features	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Workflows	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Contact Management	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
Agent Assignments	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Security & Privacy	✗	✓	✓	✓	✗
Multi-channel	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗

Cost Analysis¹



Hiver	\$25 per user/month	\$300 per user/year
Front	\$25 per user/month	\$300 per user/year
Missive	\$18 per user/month	\$216 per user/year
Help Scout	\$30 per user/month	\$360 per user/year
Shared Inbox	\$10 per user/month	\$120 per user/year

¹ All prices reflect the lowest paid tier for all companies

A high-angle, wide shot of a modern office interior. In the upper left, two people are seated at a long, light-colored wooden reception desk. One person is a man with curly hair wearing a dark blazer over a pink shirt, and the other is a woman wearing a grey sweater and a black hijab. They are looking at a laptop. The desk is made of horizontal wooden planks. To the right, a wide staircase with light-colored steps and a wooden handrail leads down. Several people are walking on the stairs, their figures slightly blurred to suggest movement. The walls are made of large, light-colored panels, and the overall atmosphere is bright and professional.

New tools

Platform Deep Dive

Front

Omni-Channel

High-growth/Scalable

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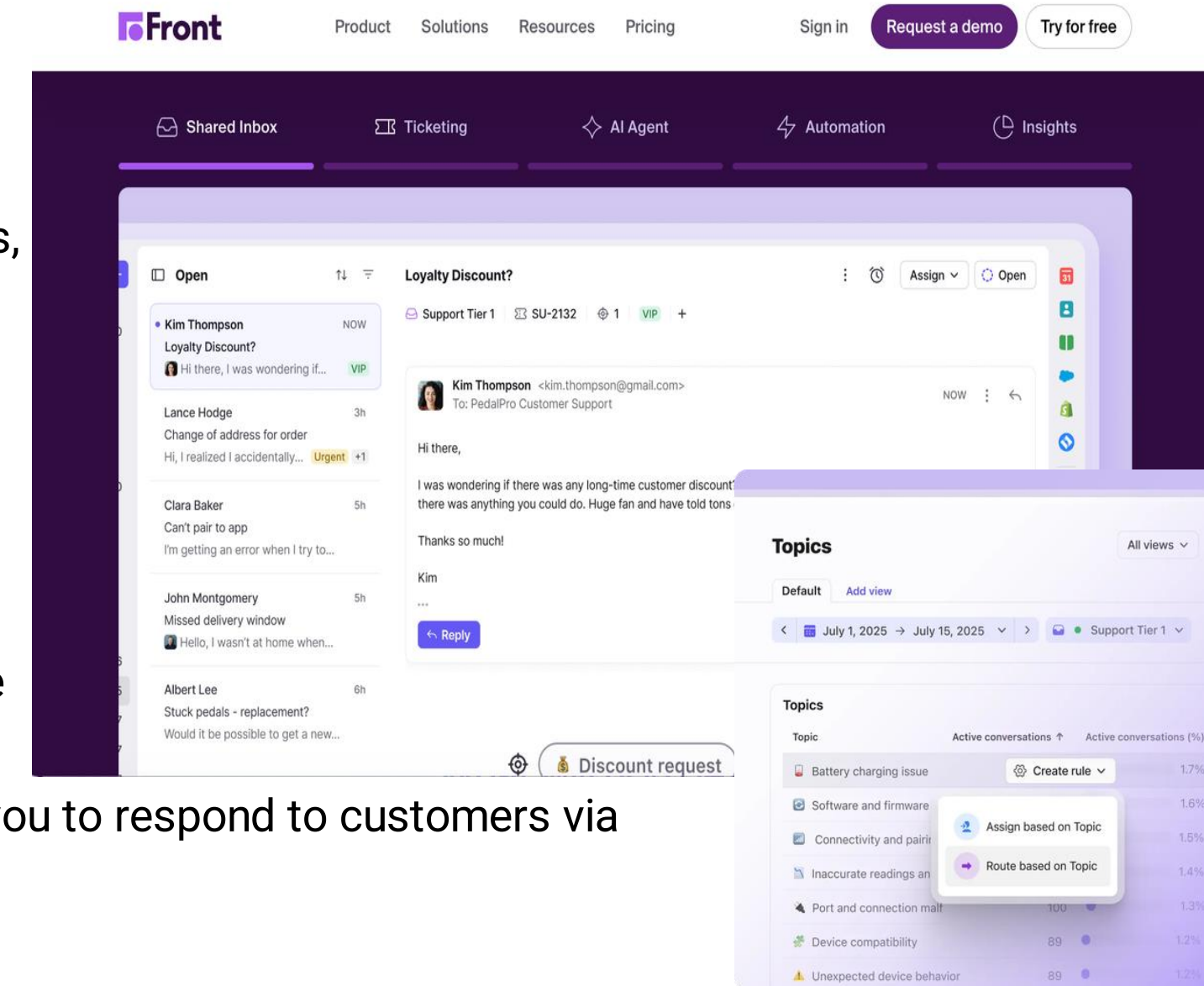
Front is a customer operations platform that uses AI to help streamline all customer communications across various channels in its dedicated front dashboard.

Key Takeaways

- **Expensive & limited feature access:** You receive a limited number of automation rules, only get unlimited smart rules at the highest price band
- **Omni-channel focused:** This is a workable solution if you want to streamline all communications, not just email, given that you are restricted at the lower tier plans
- **Limited email assignment:** Only 1 person

Key Features

- **AI functionality:** Advanced AI functionality that can analyze, craft custom responses, and even handle low-risk emails
- **Workflows:** Create advanced workflows that allow for seamless escalations and handoffs, while supporting total oversight into what is being sent to whom and when
- **Omni-Channel:** Front's dashboard lets you see all customer interactions in one place, allowing you to respond to customers via email, chat, voice & SMS, WhatsApp, Slack and more



Price point

- **Starter:** Single channel support, 10 automation rules starting at \$25 per user/month (max 10 seats)
- **Professional:** Starter plus, omnichannel support (email, SMS, social), 20+ automation rules starting at \$65 per user/month (max 50 seats)
- **Enterprise:** Professional plus, smart rules (unlimited), AI Copilot, CSAT \$105 per user/month

Hiver

Support/Email Platform

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Originally designed as a Google Chrome email management extension specifically for Gmail, **Hiver** has recently branched out to Outlook. This AI-driven solution enhances communication both internally and externally.

Key Takeaways

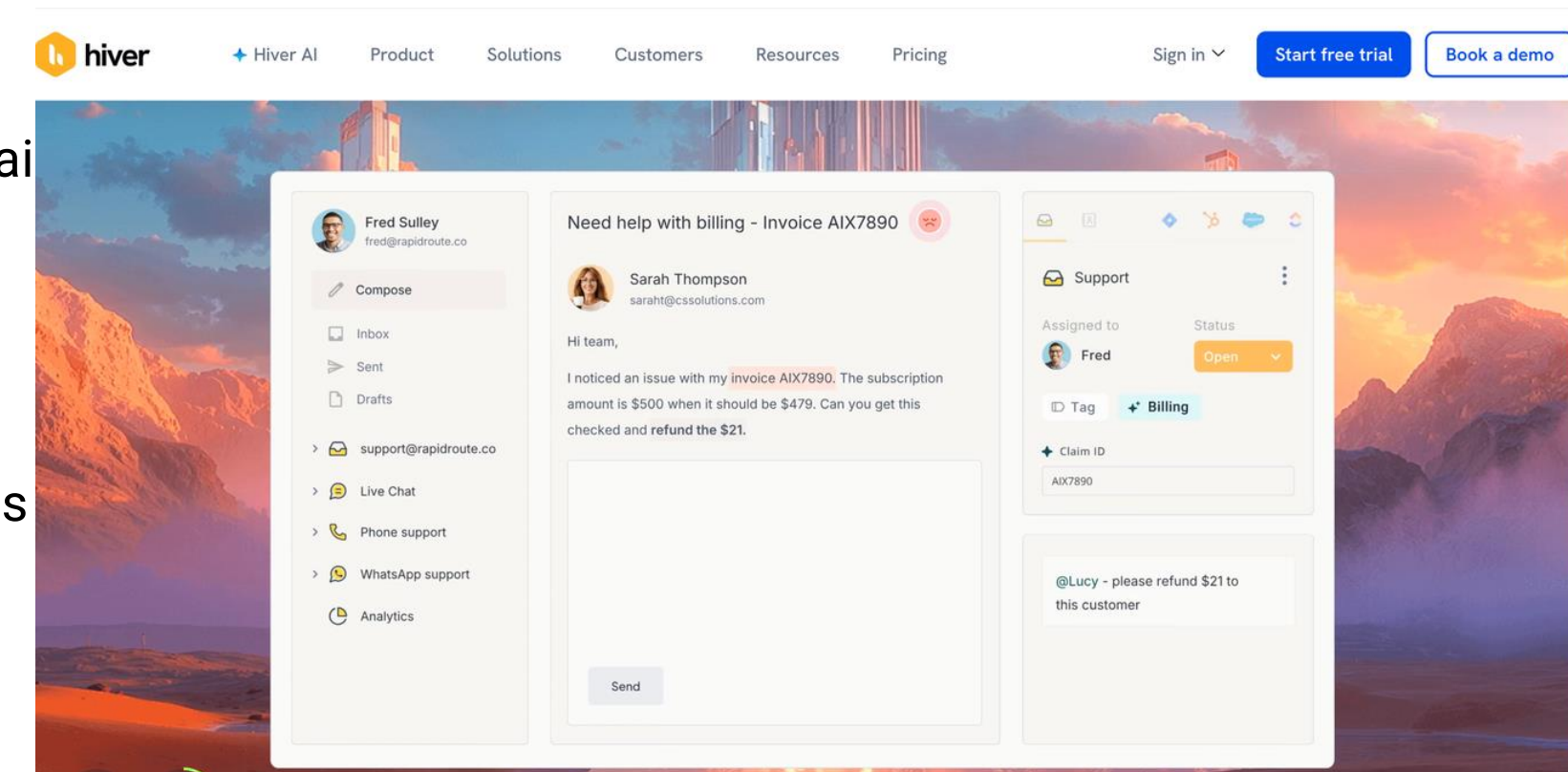
- **Security & Privacy:** Hiver prioritizes comprehensive compliance with standards such as GDPR, ISO27001, SOC2 Type II, HIPAA, and CCPA
- **Cross-Collaboration:** It places a strong emphasis on fostering collaboration and communication among teams
- **Easy Set-up:** Easy to use

Key Features

- **AI functionality:** Automate repetitive tasks, such as closing thank you emails, detecting customer sentiment, and suggesting the most relevant email templates for faster responses
- **Workflows:** Streamline operations with automated round-robin assignment and condition-based rules
- **Omni-Channel:** Delivers a unified customer experience by tracking interactions across different touchpoints in one view

Price Point

- **Free:** Shared inbox (email, live chat), Slack integration, internal notes, and comments
- **Growth:** Free plus, AI responses/summaries, workflows (automatic assignment, rules), integrations, analytics, follow-ups & alerts, starting at \$25 per user/month
- **Pro:** Growth plus, AI agent/suggestions, multi-inbox for voice, WhatsApp & Portal, CSAT, onboarding support, starting at \$65 per user/month



Shared Inbox AI

Email/Chatbot Management

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Shared Inbox is an AI-powered collaborative workspace that transforms shared team emails into an organized, automated helpdesk with real-time status tracking and smart draft suggestions.

Key Takeaways

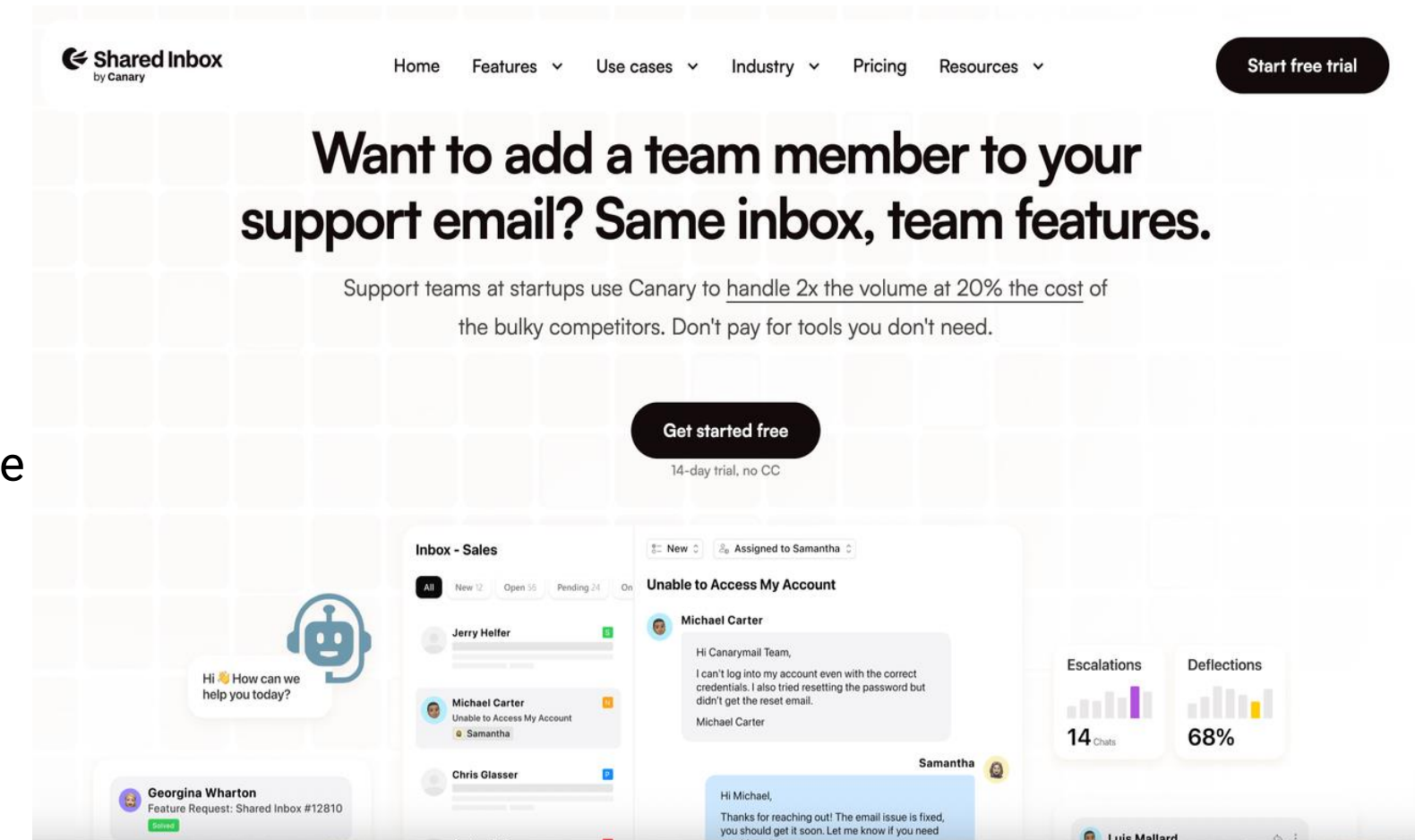
- **Slack Native:** Turns every incoming email into a Slack thread, so is best for teams who live in Slack and want simplicity
- **Team Collaboration:** Discuss customer emails via a private Slack chat before replying, ensuring the team is aligned on every response
- **Affordable pricing:** One of the cheaper solutions with plans ranging from \$10 to \$30 per user per month

Key Features

- **AI Functionality:** Implement automated status tracking and smart alerts that notify the team when an email has not received a reply within a set time limit
- **Smart Shared Folders:** Create dynamic rule-based folders that sort incoming mail by project, priority or customer
- **Team Collaboration and Communication:** Use mentions and chat sidebars within email threads, allowing team members to discuss responses privately before replying to the customer

Price Point

- **Starter:** Shared inbox, ticket assignment, shared templates, AI chatbot starting at \$10 per user/month
- **Business Plan:** Starter plus AI agent assistant/analyzer, analytics, CSAT, starting at \$20 per user/month
- **Scale Plan:** Business plus, API access, SSO, integrations, priority support, starting at \$30 per user/month



Help Scout

Help Scout is a help desk, designed for customer support teams. With access to a shared inbox, teams can deliver email support and centralize their customer communications from live chat and social media.

Key Takeaways

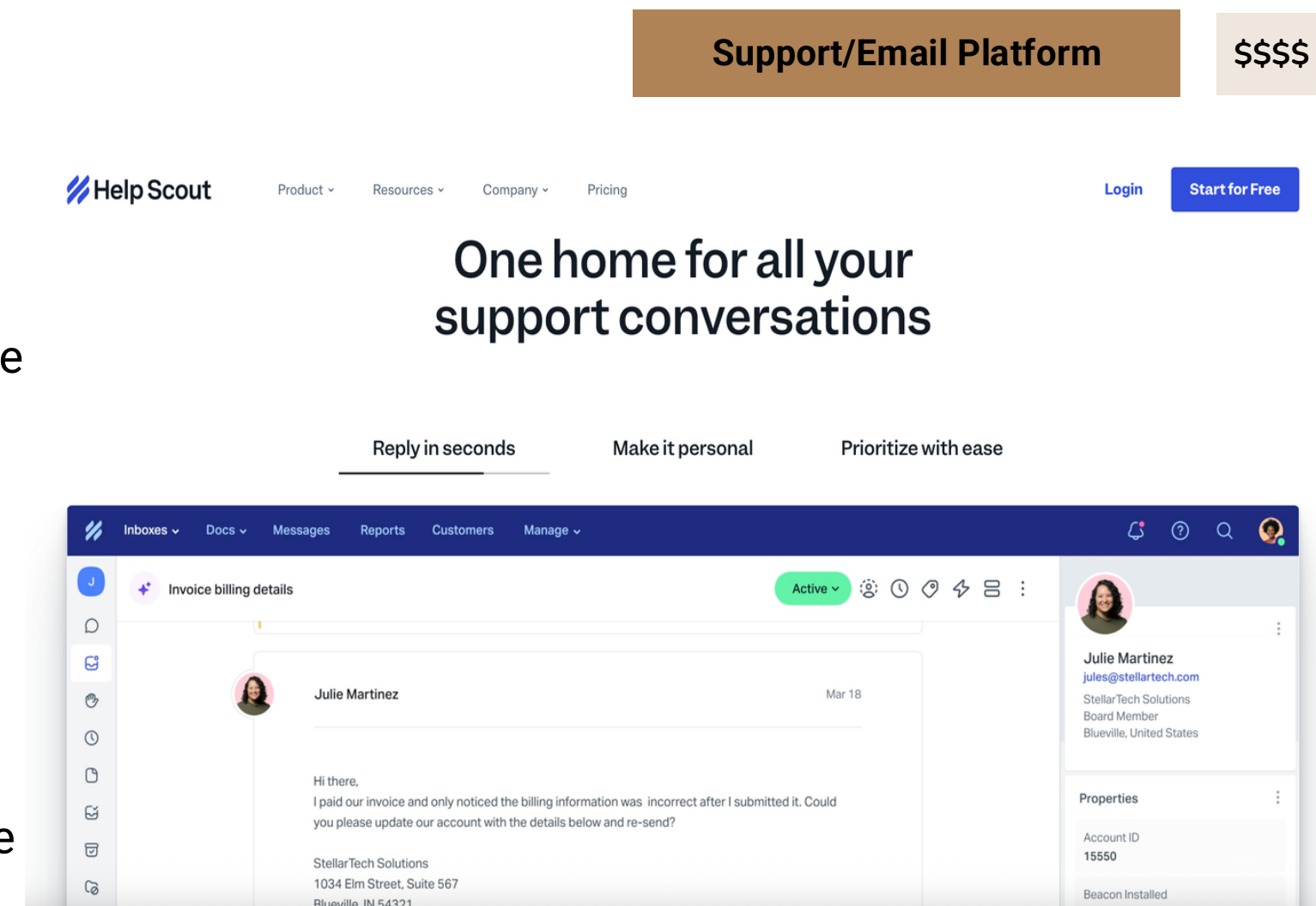
- **Contact and Company Data:** Get immediate access to the sender's full profile, their inquiry history account history, and relevant links/resources
- **Collision detection:** Visibility into what everyone is working on and which issues are being addressed in real time
- **SaaS Focused:** While it allows you to manage a shared inbox, a lot of their other features are very SaaS product heavy

Key Features

- **AI Tools:** Build a library of saved replies that let you answer FAQs, reply to emails faster with AI Drafts, summarize on long back-and-forth conversations quickly with AI Summarize, and more
- **Integrations:** Vast selection of marketing, support, CRM, communication, and analytics integrations
- **Messages:** Add messages to your website, such as pop-up boxes, banners and more to get customers through critical moments

Price Point

- **Free:** Shared inbox, limited save replies
- **Standard:** Multiple inboxes, basic workflows, tags, saved replies, and AI inbox assistant, starting at \$25 per user/month
- **Plus:** Standard plus, advanced workflows, group conversations by company, internal teams, integrations starting at \$45 per user/month
- **Pro:** Plus, unlimited workflows, SSO/SAML, dedicated support/onboarding help, starting at \$75 per user/month



Missive

Missive is a full-scale communications hub for teams that want to see all their customer touch points in one place.

Key Takeaways

- **Email Assignment:** 1 or multiple people
- **Cross Collaboration:** Focused heavily on cross-collaboration and communication with tools like draft collaboration that let you co-write emails
- **Ticketing System:** You can transform any email into a task, assigning it a due date and checkbox

Key Features:

- **Unified Multi-Channel Inbox:** Merge email, SMS, WhatsApp, and social media into one view, allowing the team to manage all customer touchpoints
- **Internal Chat and Mentions:** End the need for Slack or internal CCs by chatting directly inside email threads
- **Workflow automation:** You can set triggers based on keywords, sender, time of day, or even AI-detected sentiment

Price Point:

- **Starter:** Shared inbox (email, live chat), Slack integration, internal notes, and comments, starting at \$18 per user/month
- **Productive:** Free plus, AI responses/summaries, workflows (automatic assignment, rules), integrations, analytics, follow-ups & alerts, starting at \$30 per user/month
- **Business:** Growth plus, AI agent/suggestions, multi-inbox for voice, WhatsApp & Portal, CSAT, onboarding support, starting at \$45 per user/month

